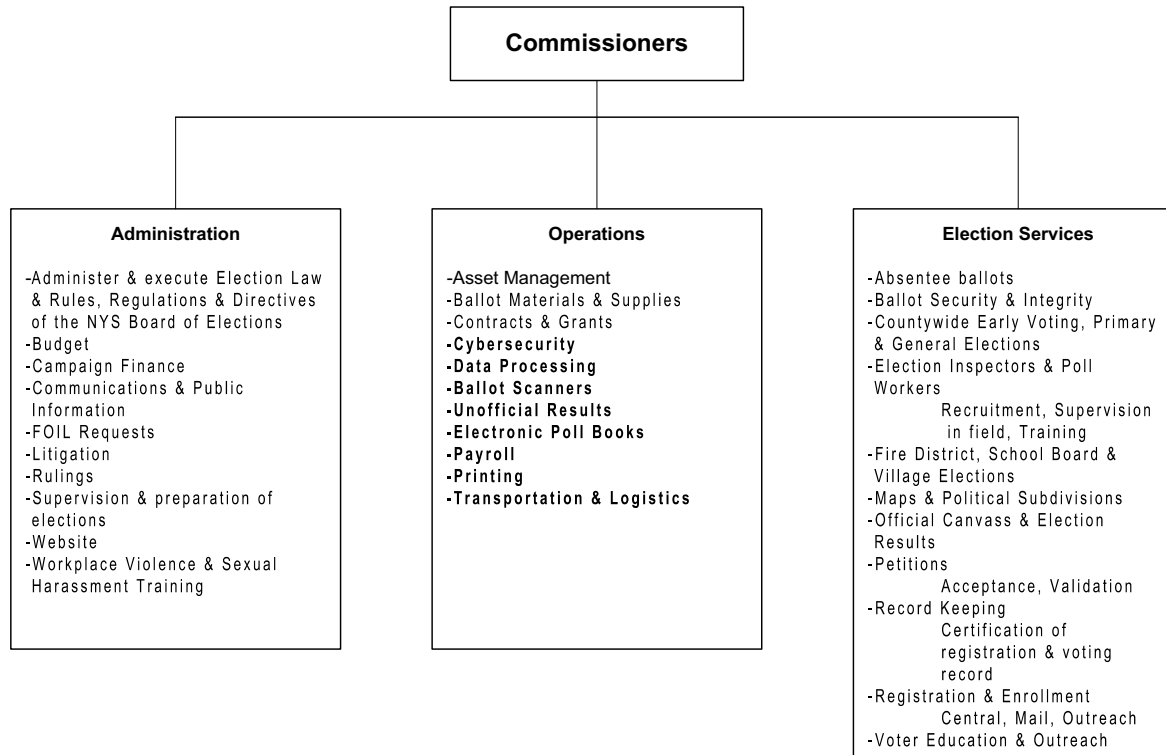


Board Of Elections (14)



One Democratic and one Republican Commissioner of Elections are recommended by their respective political party and are appointed by the Board of Legislators for a term of four years.

Board Of Elections (14)

Mission Statement

The mission of the Westchester County Board of Elections is to (1) ensure the proper conduct under law of primary, general and special elections for municipal, county, state and federal offices, and (2) ensure that every qualified voter in Westchester County has every opportunity to participate in such elections by facilitating registration in person or by mail or other lawful electronic means.

	<u>2024</u>	<u>2025</u>
POSITIONS		
Operating	106	106
Grants		
	<u>106</u>	<u>106</u>
OPERATING BUDGET EXPENDITURES		
Personal Services	12,756,374	12,615,412
Equipment	79,584	77,700
Material & Supplies	3,352,216	2,956,163
Expenses	9,540,087	11,407,375
Interdepartmental Charges	3,021,283	3,967,185
TOTAL EXPENDITURES	<u>28,749,544</u>	<u>31,023,835</u>
OPERATING BUDGET REVENUES		
Interdepartmental		
Departmental	1,833,143	1,887,838
State and Federal Aid		
TOTAL REVENUES	<u>1,833,143</u>	<u>1,887,838</u>
DEPARTMENT TAX LEVY	<u>26,916,401</u>	<u>29,135,997</u>
Estimated Share of Miscellaneous Budget Items:		
Retirement Systems	2,374,739	2,575,186
Health Insurance and Benefits	3,736,559	3,883,103
DEPARTMENT TOTAL	<u>33,027,699</u>	<u>35,594,286</u>

The Appropriated 2023 figures in the supporting detail include all budget amendments through August 31, 2024 and Appropriations Assigned for Purchases on Order ("roll forwards") of \$515,583

Board Of Elections (14)

The Board of Elections is a bipartisan board established by the Election Law of the State of New York. Its structures, responsibilities and duties are derived from the state constitutional provisions regarding suffrage and defined by New York State law and by regulations of the New York State Board of Elections.

Programs and Services

Oversee Registration by mail

Perform central Registration

Offer registration at high schools, nursing homes and V.A.
Hospitals (pre and post pandemic)

Record official canvasses of elections

Process applications for absentee ballots

Distribute absentee ballots

Accept petitions for party and independent nominations

Issue voter cards and certifications of voting records

Conduct primary, special and general elections

Conduct Early Voting for primary, special and general elections

Maintain poll records

Maintain political subdivision maps

Mandated by:

Constitution of the State of New York

Article I: Bill of Rights

Article II: Suffrage

Election Law of the State of New York (Articles 1-17 of NYS
Election Law)

Rules and Regulations of the State of New York

Subtitle V - State Board of Elections

(Regulations part 6200 - part 6219)

Board Of Elections (14)

PROGRAM AREA AND SERVICES:

GENERAL GOVERNMENT SUPPORT

- ✓ Voter registration in person, centrally, by mail or electronically from NYS DMV transactions.
- ✓ Change party enrollment and residence addresses for registered voters as requested or needed.
- ✓ Cancel registration as needed due to death, out-of-county moves and incarceration for a felony offense.
- ✓ Maintain record of registration and voting history.
- ✓ Certify voting record on request.
- ✓ Accept and process absentee ballot applications for all elections and distribute ballots to qualified voters for these.
- ✓ Provide nine (9) days of early voting for all primary, general and special elections in Westchester County at 25 locations for eight (8) hours each day.
- ✓ Recruit, train and employ poll workers to conduct elections.
- ✓ Record and certify an official canvass of every election.
- ✓ Have custody of, purchase, repair and maintain all voting equipment used to conduct elections.
- ✓ Accept, review and certify petitions for public office, party positions and propositions for ballot placement.
- ✓ Maintain maps of political subdivisions and polling locations within Westchester County.
- ✓ As needed, assist school, fire, water and library districts with training on election procedures, the use of optical scan voting machines, lists of certified Election Inspectors and programming assistance.
- ✓ For school, fire, water and library districts with agreements with the Board of Elections, lend voting machines and have Board of Elections technicians on call to assist on election days.

DEPARTMENT INITIATIVES:

NEW

- ✓ In 2024, the Board of Elections expanded early voting from 24 sites to 25 sites around Westchester adding one in Rye City. Early Voting occurs for nine days beginning on the second Saturday before the election and continues through the Sunday before the election. A voter may choose to vote at any site. All sites are ADA compliant, provide Ballot Marking Devices, as well as secure overnight storage of voting machines and support materials.
- ✓ Redistricting: The state's Independent Redistricting Commission redrew the lines for the state's 26 congressional districts in time for the June primary election.
- ✓ Bilingual Ballots: With the November 5th General Election, the Board of Elections ended the practice of using separate English-language and Spanish-language ballots and implemented the use of ballots where instructions and office titles are printed on the same ballot in both English and Spanish.
- ✓ State Legislation Affecting Process: The State Legislature persisted in taking up numerous bills affecting election processes. Two of the three bills that passed both houses but are not yet before the Governor are also included below.
 - ◆ Chapter 226 of the Laws of 2022, The John R. Lewis Voting Rights Act of New York, took effect on September 22, 2024 following the promulgation of implementing regulations by the New York State Attorney General. Westchester County, its Board of Elections, the Cities of Mount Vernon, New Rochelle and Yonkers, the Town of Greenburgh, the Village of Port Chester and the Mount Vernon School District are among its covered entities. As a result of this status, preclearance review is required for election changes by a covered entity if the changes constitute "covered policies." Covered policies "shall include any new or modified voting qualification, prerequisite to voting, law, ordinance, standard, practice, procedure, regulation, or policy concerning" the topics in NYVRA:
 - a) Method of Election;
 - b) Form of government;

Board Of Elections (14)

- c) Annexation of a political subdivision;
 - d) Incorporation of a political subdivision;
 - e) Consolidation or division of political subdivisions;
 - f) Removal of voters from enrollment lists or other list maintenance activities;
 - g) Number, location, or hours of any election day or early voting poll site;
 - h) Dates of elections and the election calendar, except with respect to special elections;
 - i) Registration of voters;
 - j) Assignment of election districts to election day or early voting poll sites; and
 - k) Assistance offered to members of a language-minority group.
- ◆ Chapter 741 of the Laws of 2023 (“The Even Years Elections bill”) moves most town and many county office elections to even years starting in 2025 and completing the transition in 2030. Not affected are Town Justices and any elected town officer with a three-year term. On the County level, not affected are the offices of Sheriff, County Clerk, District Attorney, Family Court Judge, County Court Judge, Surrogate and any county officer with a three-year term.
 - ◆ Chapter 214 of the Laws of 2024 deems pre-registered voters who are or will be eighteen years of age on the day of an election qualified voters for the purposes of absentee voting and early mail voting.
 - ◆ Chapter 217 of the Laws of 2024 modifies the order in which candidates appear on the ballot by requiring offices be listed in descending order based on the electorate size and requiring certain federal offices to be listed before state, county or local offices.
 - ◆ Chapter 220 of the Laws of 2024 requires postage paid envelopes for returning ballot cure affirmations and permits return by mail, in person or via electronic form as an e-mail attachment while setting the cure return to a date certain.
 - ◆ A1244D/S612D would bar board of elections employees from remaining on the payroll while also a candidate for an office overseen by their board except if running for district leader or member of a county committee. (If there is no primary for the office, the employee may remain on board until 90 days before the general election.)
 - ◆ A7243/S610 would authorize local Boards of Elections to establish absentee ballot drop-off locations using “secure receptacles.”
 - ✓ Village Elections for Bronxville, Dobbs Ferry, Elmsford, Hastings, Pleasantville, Port Chester, Rye Brook and Sleepy Hollow will continue to be held in March as needed. Tuckahoe Village Elections will be held in November, as needed.
 - ✓ Upgrade of electronic poll pads and voting machines: With routine wear and tear and changes in technology, the time has come to replace the 1,000 “Plan A” voting machines and upgrade the 2,200 electronic poll books now in use. Some grant funding is available for the acquisition of new electronic poll books. Project BEL04 already contains \$2.5 million in 2024 for voting equipment. An additional \$10 million is requested for 2025 to completely fund the purchase of the electronic poll books and 1,000 new voting machines.

ONGOING

- ✓ COVID-19 response: As of this writing, the community risk level for Westchester County remains “low.”
- ✓ Cybersecurity: Working with the Department of Information Technology, which has lead responsibility for managing the Board's networks, data storage, systems cybersecurity and incident recovery efforts, inter alia, the Board of Elections continues its cybersecurity

Board Of Elections (14)

program. Tabletop exercises on preventing, detecting and responding to a cybersecurity incident were held with our federal and state partners throughout the year.

- ✓ Online Training: In addition to in-person classes, the Board of Elections offers online training for potential poll workers since 2021. Westchester County residents and registered voters can register from their mobile devices, desktops, or laptops: <https://boeie.westchestergov.com>.

DEPARTMENT ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

- ✓ Asset management: The Asset Management Inventory System tracks all voting machines, electronic poll pads, election supplies and equipment for accessibility through delivery and then pick up by contracted movers to the 25 early voting and the up to 329 election day polling sites. In between elections, voting machines are tested, prepared and repaired if necessary.
- ✓ Election Inspector Recruitment, Training and Support: The implementation of online training in procedures followed by an online examination, allows the Board to concentrate in-person training to operating the electronic poll pads and voting machines. As a result, polling places remain adequately staffed despite recurring recruiting difficulties. To aid recruitment during the Presidential Election year, two county-wide mailings were made.
- ✓ Polling Places: The Board opens and operates 329 polling places for county-wide elections.
- ✓ Serving the Spanish-speaking: The 2020 Census reports that 27% of Westchester residents are of Hispanic origin, up from 22% in 2010, demonstrating the continuing need for the Board of Elections' aggressive efforts to assist Hispanic voters and employ bilingual poll workers.
- ✓ Unofficial results: To offer unofficial results on election night, it takes the cooperation of town and city clerks, polling site agents, election inspectors, temporary Election Day workers and the Board's own staff. Almost 1,000 memory cards come back to either the Board of Elections central office in White Plains or the Ardsley warehouse data center to produce the results within hours after the polls close.

- ✓ Voter outreach: Forms and up-to-date information are available at all local public libraries and at the offices of village, town and city clerks. Information on becoming a poll worker and video demonstrations for operating the electronic machinery used for voting are available on the Board's website. Presentations on participating in the election process, from voting to working the polls to running for office, are available once again by contacting the Commissioners' offices.
- ✓ Voter registration: Maintaining accurate voter registration records is a year-round process with daily tasks. Forms come from multiple sources - NYS DMV records, mail, in person, electronically, etc. The Board receives changes of address and information about moves out-of-county and deaths of registered voters year-round and make the maintaining of accurate records a process with daily tasks. Slower mail delivery standards of the USPS makes timely processing of new registrations just prior to an election more and more challenging, particularly since an eligible person may register to vote on the first day of early voting and vote the same day.

REVENUES:

- ✓ Departmental revenues derive from grants and fees.
- ✓ Fees are based on a published rate chart for services such as production of registration and enrollment lists (printed and on digital media), political subdivision maps, verification of voter registration and photo copies of documents such as petitions, acceptances and declinations.
- ✓ The Election Law permits billing municipalities for the costs of elections to include poll workers, the printing of ballots, the moving and storage of voting machines and the rental of polling places.
- ✓ Limited grants are currently available to the Westchester County Board of Elections for expenses incurred during the current State Fiscal Year which ends on March 31, 2025. The TIER grant can support the purchase of the next generation of electronic poll pads. Smaller grants can be used to offset postage expenses for absentee ballot return, education and training programs in support of the Help America Vote Act and to improve poll site access for persons with disabilities.

Board Of Elections (14)

SERVICE INDICATORS:

	2023 Actual	2024 Estimated	2025 Planned		2023 Actual	2024 Estimated	2025 Planned
Westchester voters registered (active and inactive)	655,409	687,806*	700,000	Absentee/Early Vote By Mail Ballots Distributed:			
Total registration forms processed	20,000	35,000	25,000	Presidential Primary	n/a	8,298	n/a
				June Primary	9,018	13,134	30,000
				Village Elections	695	511*	700
				Special Elections	610	Apr 397* Jul 508*	unknown
				General Election	27,550	65,000	40,000
				Number of election districts	907	906	906
				Number of Polling Places:			
				Early Voting	24	25	25
				Primary Election(s)	119	329	Up to 329
				General Election	331	329	329

*Actual.

Board Of Elections (14)

Objects of Expenditure		Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
Personal Service:							
Annual-Regular:	GROUP						
Commissioner		2	2	2	2	2	2
Deputy Commissioner	XVI	2	2	2	2	2	2
Director of Technical Services	XIV	8	8	8	8	8	8
Program Administrator	XII	12	12	12	12	12	12
Supervising Voting Mach. Tech	XII	2	2	2	2	2	2
Program Specialist	X	26	26	26	26	26	26
Voting Machine Tech	X	10	10	10	10	10	10
Executive Secretary to Comm.	X	2	2	2	2	2	2
Jr. Administrative Assistant	VIII	3	3	3	3	3	3
Staff Asst. (Board of Elections)	VIII		11	11	11	11	11
Sr. Clerk-Board of Elections	VIII	11					
Supervisor of Poll Records	VIII	2	2	2	2	2	2
Clerk-Board of Elections	VII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Unit Record Supervisor	VII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Office Asst.	VI	4	4	4	4	4	4
Payroll Clerk	VI	1	1	1	1	1	1
Supervising File Clerk	VI	1	1	1	1	1	1
Sr. Clerk (Board of elections)	V		18	18	18	18	18
Sr. File Clerk	V	1					
Sr. Clerk	V	9					
Receptionist	IV	2					
Int. File Clerk	III	6					
Total Positions		106	106	106	106	106	106

Board Of Elections (14)

Account Class	Account Rollup Name	Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
100 Annual Regular Salaries	1010 Net-Annual Regular	8,770,967	9,706,374	9,706,374	9,706,374	10,165,412	9,915,412
		8,770,967	9,706,374	9,706,374	9,706,374	10,165,412	9,915,412
101 Other Personal Services	1200 Hourly	166,942	500,000	500,000	500,000	500,000	500,000
	1400 Overtime	1,675,167	2,550,000	2,550,000	2,550,000	2,200,000	2,200,000
		1,842,109	3,050,000	3,050,000	3,050,000	2,700,000	2,700,000
200 Equipment	2300 Replacement	12,434	77,700	79,584	77,700	77,700	77,700
	2400 Additional	125,139	0	0	0	0	0
		137,573	77,700	79,584	77,700	77,700	77,700
300 Material & Supplies	3010 Automotive Supplies	982	5,000	5,000	5,000	5,000	5,000
	3600 Printing & Office Suppl	1,054,136	2,250,000	2,277,216	2,250,000	2,101,163	2,101,163
	3700 Postage Costs	383,816	1,070,000	1,070,000	1,070,000	850,000	850,000
		1,438,934	3,325,000	3,352,216	3,325,000	2,956,163	2,956,163
400 Expenses	4070 Equip Service & Rental	594,603	956,595	956,645	956,595	1,695,690	1,695,690
	4110 Travel and Meals	53,588	70,000	70,000	70,000	100,000	100,000
	4250 Public & Legal Notices	29,770	50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000
	4280 Insurance	106,325	115,000	123,000	115,000	149,500	149,500
	4310 Non-recurring Repairs	0	0	0	0	250,000	1,544,400
	4380 Contractual Services	2,378,255	1,696,560	1,721,792	1,696,560	1,696,560	1,696,560
	4420 Technical Services	2,898,095	6,165,450	6,618,650	6,165,450	6,171,225	6,171,225
		6,060,636	9,053,605	9,540,087	9,053,605	10,112,975	11,407,375
599 Inter-Departmental Charge	5205 Information Support Svc	1,884,298	2,060,291	2,060,291	2,060,291	2,309,866	2,478,782
	5280 Svc by Public Works	859,688	841,005	841,005	841,005	871,475	1,368,314
	5325 Svc by Dept of Law	106,398	113,045	113,045	113,045	113,458	110,981
	5390 Svc by Public Safety	14,980	6,942	6,942	6,942	9,108	9,108
		2,865,364	3,021,283	3,021,283	3,021,283	3,303,907	3,967,185
Total Expenditures		21,115,583	28,233,962	28,749,545	28,233,962	29,316,157	31,023,835
Net Expenditures		21,115,583	28,233,962	28,749,545	28,233,962	29,316,157	31,023,835

Board Of Elections (14)

Account Class	Account Rollup Name	Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
50 Departmental Income		1,756,779	1,833,143	1,833,143	1,833,143	1,887,838	1,887,838
97 State Aid		2,178,924	0	0	0	0	0
Total Revenues		3,935,703	1,833,143	1,833,143	1,833,143	1,887,838	1,887,838
Net Department Total		17,179,880	26,400,819	26,916,402	26,400,819	27,428,319	29,135,997